

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Zen; B) Pure Land; C) Theravada; D) Tibetan

Note: Zen Buddhism was the first form of Buddhism to gain widespread popularity in North America, particularly in the mid-20 th century, due to its emphasis on meditation practices and its appeal to the counterculture movement.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) God is eternal and merciful to those who offer worship; B) Humans can align themselves with life energy through worship of kami; C) Justice will be the final outcome in the next world; D) Power and force are the most divine attributes

Note: The concept of a merciful and eternal God is central to various Japanese religious practices, particularly in Shinto and Buddhism, highlighting the importance of spirituality and worship in shaping Japanese cultural values and identity.

3. **Answer:** C

Options: A) 1749-1945; B) 1052-1616; C) 1641-1853; D) 1517-1870

Note: The correct answer is 1641-1853 because during this period, known as Sakoku, Japan enacted a policy of isolation that included the expulsion of Christian missionaries and the prohibition of Christianity to maintain control over foreign influence and preserve Japanese culture.

4. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Confucianism; B) Buddhism; C) Christianity; D) Daoism

Note: Confucianism was imposed upon Koreans during Japan's occupation as part of a broader strategy to suppress Korean culture and identity while promoting Japanese values and social order.

5. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Ban Zhao; B) Laozi; C) Menicus; D) Liu Xiang

Note: Ban Zhao is the correct answer because she is a renowned Chinese scholar and poet from the Han dynasty, known for her work "Admonitions for Women," which provides guidance on women's roles and virtues in society.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Great Cloud Sutra does not mention Wang Yangming, as it is a Buddhist text that focuses on Buddhist teachings rather than Confucian philosophy and its figures.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Dharma, which encompasses the teachings and doctrines of the Buddha, is one of the Three Gems of Buddhism, alongside the Buddha himself and the Sangha, making the statement true.

8. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Guru Hargobind is recognized for wearing two swords, with one representing spiritual authority and the other signifying temporal power, highlighting the Sikh principle of balancing both aspects of life.

9. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Guru Tegh Bahadur was martyred in 1675 for his steadfast refusal to convert to Islam under pressure from the Mughal Empire, which sought to impose religious uniformity.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Marduk became the chief deity of Babylon and replaced Enlil as the supreme god in Mesopotamian mythology, particularly after his victory over Tiamat, which solidified his position in the pantheon.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** Hwanung plays a crucial role in the Korean foundation myth as the divine son of the heavenly ruler, who descends to Earth to establish a civilization. His transformation into a human symbolizes the connection between the divine and earthly realms, emphasizing the importance of divine guidance in the formation of society. This transformation leads to the birth of Dangun, the legendary founder of the Korean nation, who represents the unity of heaven, earth, and humanity. As a result, Hwanung's story not only illustrates the origins of the Korean people but also reinforces cultural values such as harmony, respect for nature, and the belief in a shared ancestry. Ultimately, Hwanung's influence on Dangun and the narrative reflects a deep-seated national identity that cherishes its spiritual roots.

Note: correct because it effectively highlights Hwanung's role as a divine figure whose transformation into a human signifies the integration of divine influence in establishing civilization, culminating in the birth of Dangun, which reinforces the cultural identity of Korea through the unity of heaven, earth, and humanity.

12. **Answer:** The Kaddish is a significant prayer in Jewish mourning practices that has played a crucial role since the Middle Ages. It is recited by mourners during the mourning period and in synagogue services, serving as a way to honor the deceased while affirming faith in God. The Kaddish helps the grieving process by providing a

structured opportunity for mourners to express their sorrow and connect with their community, reinforcing the idea that they are not alone in their grief. Additionally, this prayer serves as a reminder of the continuity of life and the importance of memory, allowing families to maintain a spiritual bond with their loved ones. Ultimately, the Kaddish fosters healing and communal support, making it a vital component of Jewish mourning rituals.

Note: correct because it emphasizes the Kaddish's role in honoring the deceased, affirming faith, and facilitating community support, all of which are essential elements in the grieving process within Jewish mourning practices since the Middle Ages.